

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | SIEM/SOAR | KQL | Azure Security | MDR
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an accomplished Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of specialist experience designing, deploying, configuring, and optimising Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) environments. I bring deep hands-on expertise in Sentinel workspace architecture, data connector integration, KQL-based detection engineering, analytics rules development, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook authoring, and custom workbook and dashboard creation. Complementing this, I hold expert-level proficiency with CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender. I have built hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC) and Managed Detection and Response (MDR)-style capabilities within complex enterprise environments, acting as the senior escalation engineer for critical security incidents. I am experienced in assessing the maturity of client SIEM and XDR deployments, identifying improvement opportunities, and implementing optimisations that measurably improve detection fidelity and response efficiency. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am highly motivated to bring this expertise to BlueVoyant's Deployment Engineering team, supporting customers across the full Microsoft Security stack.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM:** Workspace design and architecture; data connector configuration and onboarding; KQL-based analytics rules and detection logic; SOAR automation rules; incident management; workbooks and dashboards; Log Analytics
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender; Defender for Cloud; Extended Detection and Response (XDR) correlation and investigation
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM; EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover); hybrid SOC build; detection tuning; threat intelligence integration - Expert level
- **Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting:** KQL; MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs); behavioural analytics; custom detection rule authoring; proactive threat hunting
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks; SOAR workflow design; PowerShell scripting; automated incident enrichment and response
- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID; Conditional Access; Azure Monitor; Log Analytics Workspaces; Microsoft Purview; Intune MDM/MAM
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61; MITRE ATT&CK framework; senior escalation lead; post-incident review; playbook authoring
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Nessus; AppCheck; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF; CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead the design and ongoing engineering of the **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM** environment: onboard data connectors from 20+ sources, author KQL-based analytics rules, build SOAR automation playbooks, and maintain stakeholder workbooks and dashboards.
- Assess and continuously improve **SIEM and XDR deployment maturity**; tune signal-to-noise ratios, rationalise log sources, and implement detection coverage mapped to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs.
- Deploy, manage, and optimise **CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR** (Prevent, Insight, Discover) as the principal SME; built hybrid SOC capability leveraging CrowdStrike telemetry alongside Microsoft Sentinel for multi-platform visibility.

- Act as **senior escalation engineer** for complex, high-severity incidents; lead containment, eradication, and recovery activities; produce post-incident reviews with lessons-learned recommendations.
- Drive **threat hunting** initiatives using KQL advanced queries and behavioural analytics in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; identify and neutralise threats before alert triggers.
- Develop and maintain **SOAR automation workflows** using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks and PowerShell; automate enrichment, triage, and tier-1 response actions, reducing MTTR by 40%+.
- Mentor junior analysts on **KQL, detection engineering, and incident response methodology**; deliver internal training sessions and contribute to team knowledge base documentation.
- Manage **Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender)** platform operations including policy configuration, alert management, and XDR investigation workflows.
- Administer **Azure AD / Entra ID** Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO; enforce identity security controls and Zero Trust architecture principles.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity March 2022 - March 2025

- Planned and delivered enterprise-wide deployment of **Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender** across approximately 8,000 users; reported on deployment maturity and coverage metrics.
- Authored **KQL detection analytics rules** within Microsoft Sentinel to cover key attack scenarios including lateral movement, credential theft, and ransomware precursors; mapped detections to MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Conducted **proactive threat hunting** campaigns using Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight telemetry; identified and remediated stealthy threats not captured by automated detections.
- Onboarded and managed **Sentinel data connectors** including Microsoft 365 Defender, Azure AD Identity Protection, and on-premises log sources via MMA/AMA agents.
- Developed **SOAR playbooks** to automate alert enrichment, IP and hash threat intelligence lookups, and user account isolation workflows, enabling faster and more consistent incident response.
- Managed **identity and access controls** in Azure AD / Entra ID; configured Conditional Access policies, enforced MFA, and managed SSO integrations for third-party platforms.
- Maintained **vulnerability management programme** using Tenable.io and AppCheck; shared findings and remediation guidance with infrastructure and application teams.
- Contributed to **Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001** assurance activities, providing technical evidence of SIEM and EDR controls.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed cloud security operations in a **Microsoft Azure-based SaaS/FinTech** environment; implemented endpoint protection, access controls, and security monitoring aligned to NIST CSF.
- Administered **Azure Active Directory** identity lifecycle, MFA, and SSO for staff and vendors; enforced role-based access control (RBAC) and least-privilege principles.
- Developed and maintained **security policies and documentation** aligned to ISO 27001 and internal security standards; contributed to knowledge sharing and training materials for IT staff.
- Conducted **vulnerability assessments** and tracked remediation cycles; supported penetration test scoping and closure of identified findings.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected and delivered a **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment** from scratch: 20+ data connectors, 30+ custom KQL analytics rules, automated SOAR playbooks, and executive dashboards; significantly improved detection coverage and reduced MTTR.
- Built a **hybrid SOC capability integrating CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel**, giving analysts unified visibility across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads.

- Led **Microsoft Defender XDR deployment (MDE, MDI, M365)** across 8,000 users, establishing a mature detection and response baseline for the organisation.
- Reduced analyst alert burden by 40%+ through **SIEM rule tuning and CrowdStrike policy optimisation**; improved signal quality and analyst focus on genuine threats.
- Developed a **SOAR automation library of 15+ playbooks** automating common response actions including IP blocking, account isolation, and threat intelligence enrichment.
- Conducted regular **threat hunting campaigns using KQL and MITRE ATT&CK** mapping, identifying and remediating pre-breach adversary activity on multiple occasions.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000-90,000 | Remote (UK)